

OFFICIAL SPEECH TRANSCRIPT — SPEECH 1
GENERAL OPENING STATEMENT

AGENDA ITEM
General Opening Statement

Honorable Chair, Distinguished Delegates,

The delegation of Croatia is deeply honored to address the North Atlantic Council.

As a NATO member since 2009, Croatia stands in full solidarity with Ukraine. We strongly condemn Russia's illegal and brutal aggression, which violates international law and targets innocent civilian lives.

For Croatia, this conflict is deeply personal. In the 1990s, our nation experienced the devastating pain of war, civilian displacement, and the long process of rebuilding. We know exactly what the Ukrainian people are going through today.

As a country on the Southern Flank, we must also emphasize that the security of our Alliance is indivisible. This war directly impacts the security of the Black Sea and the Mediterranean, maritime trade, and irregular migration flows. Therefore, we must apply a "360-degree security" approach. We cannot separate the safety of the East from the safety of the South.

Dear delegates, protecting civilian lives is our primary duty. Croatia is ready to share its historical experience and cooperate to find real, humanitarian solutions.

Thank you, and I yield my time back to the Chair.

Delegation of Croatia
North Atlantic Council Session